

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 12

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

133. Chapter 12 Verses 1-2

VERSE 12.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
एवं सततयुक्ता ये भक्तास्त्वां पर्युपासते ।
ये चाप्यक्षरमव्यक्तं तेषां के योगवित्तमाः ॥१॥

arjuna uvācha
evam satata-yuktā ye bhaktās tvām paryupāsate
ye chāpy akṣharam avyaktam teṣhām ke yoga-vittamāḥ

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **evam**—thus; **satata**—steadfastly; **yuktāḥ**—devoted; **ye**—those; **bhaktāḥ**—devotees; **tvām**—you; **paryupāsate**—worship; **ye**—those; **cha**—and; **api**—also; **akṣharam**—the imperishable; **avyaktam**—the formless Brahman; **teṣhām**—of them; **ke**—who; **yoga-vit-tamāḥ**—more perfect in Yog

TRANSLATION Arjuna said: Thus, those who worship You, ever steadfast, and also those who meditate on the unmanifest Imperishable Brahman of the two types of seekers, who are superior knowers of yoga? ON

VERSE 12.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

मय्यावेश्य मनो ये मां नित्ययुक्ता उपासते ।

श्रद्धया परयोपेतास्ते मे युक्ततमा मताः ॥ २ ॥

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha

mayy āveśhya mano ye mām nitya-yuktā upāsate

śhraddhayā parayopetās te me yuktatamā matāḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Lord said; mayi—on Me; āveśhya—fix; manah—the mind; ye—those; mām—Me; nitya yuktāḥ—always engaged; upāsate—worship; śhraddhayā—with faith; parayā—best; upetāḥ—endowed; te—they; me—by Me; yukta-tamāḥ—situated highest in Yog; matāḥ—I consider

The Blessed Lord said: With mind established in Me, ever steadfast in their devotion, endowed with the highest faith, those who worship Me, they are in my opinion, the best of yogis.

134. Chapter 12 Verses 3-4

VERSE 12.3-4

ये त्वक्षरमनिर्देश्यमव्यक्तं पर्युपासते ।
सर्वत्रगमचिन्त्यञ्च कूटस्थमचलन्ध्रुवम् ॥ 3 ॥
सन्नियम्येन्द्रियग्रामं सर्वत्र समबुद्धयः ।
ते प्राप्नुवन्ति मामेव सर्वभूतहिते रताः ॥ 4 ॥

ye tv akṣharam anirdeśhyam avyaktaṁ paryupāsate
sarvatra-gam achintyañcha kūṭa-stham achalandhruvam
sanniyamyendriya-grāmaṁ sarvatra sama-buddhayaḥ
te prāpnuvanti mām eva sarva-bhūta-hite ratāḥ

ye—who; tu—but; akṣharam—the imperishable; anirdeśhyam—the indefinable; avyaktaṁ—the unmanifest; paryupāsate—worship; sarvatra-gam—the all-pervading; achintyam—the unthinkable; cha—and; kūṭa-stham—the unchanging; achalam—the immovable; dhruvam—the eternal; sanniyamya—restraining; indriya-grāmam—the senses; sarvatra—everywhere; sama-buddhayaḥ—even-minded; te—they; prāpnuvanti—attain; mām—Me; eva—also; sarva-bhūta-hite—in the welfare of all beings; ratāḥ—engaged

Those who, having restrained well all the senses, even-minded everywhere, rejoicing in the welfare of all beings, meditate on the indefinable, eternal, all-pervading, and Imperishable Brahman – they attain Me alone.

135. Chapter 12 Verses 5-7

VERSE 12.5

क्लेशोऽधिकतरस्तेषामव्यक्तासक्तचेतसाम् ॥
अव्यक्ता हि गतिर्दुःखं देहवद्भिरवाप्यते ॥ 5 ॥

kleśho 'dhikataras teṣhām avyaktāsakta-chetasām
avyaktā hi gatiḥ duḥkhaṁ dehavadbhir avāpyate

kleśhaḥ—tribulations; **adhika-taraḥ**—full of; **teṣhām**—of those; **avyakta**—to the unmanifest; **āsakta**—attached; **chetasām**—whose minds; **avyaktā**—the unmanifest; **hi**—indeed; **gatiḥ**—path; **duḥkham**—exceedingly difficult; **dehavadbhiḥ**—for the embodied; **avāpyate**—is reached

Greater is the difficulty for those whose mind is set on the realisation of the unmanifest (Nirguna Brahman), because the unmanifested is reached with difficulty by embodied beings.

ये तु सर्वाणि कर्माणि मयि संन्यस्य मत्परः ।
अनन्येनैव योगेन मां ध्यायन्त उपासते ॥ 6 ॥
तेषामहं समुद्धर्ता मृत्युसंसारसागरात् ।
भवामि नचिरात्पार्थ मय्यावेशितचेतसाम् ॥ 7 ॥

ye tu sarvāṇi karmāṇi mayi sannyasya mat-parah
ananyenaiva yogena mām dhyāyanta upāsate
teṣhām aham samuddhartā mṛityu-saṁsāra-sāgarāt
bhavāmi na chirāt pārtha mayy āveśhita-chetasām

ye—who; tu—but; sarvāṇi—all; karmāṇi—actions; mayi—to Me; sannyasya—dedicating; mat-parah—regarding Me as the Supreme goal; ananyena—exclusively; eva—certainly; yogena—with devotion; mām—Me; dhyāyantaḥ—meditating; upāsate—worship; teṣhām—of those; aham—I; samuddhartā—the deliverer; mṛityu-saṁsāra-sāgarāt—from the ocean of birth and death; bhavāmi—(I) become; na—not; chirāt—after a long time; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; mayi—with Me; āveśhita chetasām—of those whose consciousness is united

O Arjuna! Those verily who renounce all actions in Me, think of Me as the only refuge and worship Me with single-minded devotion and Dhyana, to them I become the saviour and quickly lift them up from the ocean of death and ‘samsara’.

136. Chapter 12 Verse 8

VERSE 12.8

मय्येव मन आधत्स्व मयि बुद्धिं निवेशय ।
निवसिष्यसि मय्येव अत ऊर्ध्वं न संशयः ॥८॥

mayy eva mana ādhatsva mayi buddhim niveśhaya
nivasishyasi mayy eva ata ūrdhvaṁ na sanśhayaḥ

mayi—on Me; **eva**—alone; **manaḥ**—mind; **ādhatsva**—fix; **mayi**—on Me; **buddhim**—intellect; **niveśhaya**—surrender; **nivasishyasi**—you shall always live; **mayi**—in Me; **eva**—alone; **ataḥ ūrdhvaṁ**—thereafter; **na**—not; **sanśhayaḥ**—doubt

Fix the mind firmly in Me only; place the intellect in Me, thereafter you shall live in Me only; there is no doubt about this.

137. Chapter 12 Verses 9-11

VERSE 12.9

अथ चित्तं समाधातुं न शक्नोषि मयि स्थिरम् ।
अभ्यासयोगेन ततो मामिच्छाप्तुं धनञ्जय ॥९॥

atha chittaṁ samādhātum na śhaknoṣhi mayi sthiram
abhyāsa-yogena tato mām ichchhāptum dhanañjaya

atha—if; **chittam**—mind; **samādhātum**—to fix; **na śhaknoṣhi**—(you) are unable; **mayi**—on Me; **sthiram**—steadily; **abhyāsa-yogena**—by uniting with God through repeated practice; **tataḥ**—then; **mām**—me; **ichchhā**—desire; **āptum**—to attain; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun, the conqueror of wealth

O Arjuna! If you are not able to fix the mind firmly in Me, then desire to reach Me by the yoga of constant practice. (Practise constantly and fix the mind in Me).

VERSE 12.10

अभ्यासेऽप्यसमर्थोऽसि मत्कर्मपरमो भव ।
मदर्थमपि कर्माणि कुर्वन्सिद्धिमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 10 ॥

abhyāse 'py asamartho 'si mat-karma-paramo bhava
mad-artham api karmāṇi kurvan siddhim avāpsyasi

abhyāse—in practice; **api**—if; **asamarthaḥ**—unable; **asi**—you; **mat-karma paramaḥ**—devotedly work for Me; **bhava**—be; **mat-artham**—for My sake; **api**—also; **karmāṇi**—work; **kurvan**—performing; **siddhim**—perfection; **avāpsyasi**—you shall achieve

**Even if you are not capable of practice, do work for My sake;
By doing work for my sake also, you shall attain perfection.**

VERSE 12.11

अथैतदप्यशक्तोऽसि कर्तुं मद्योगमाश्रितः ।
सर्वकर्मफलत्यागं ततः कुरु यतात्मवान् ॥ 11 ॥

athaitad apy aśhakto 'si kartum mad-yogam āśhritaḥ
sarva-karma-phala-tyāgaṁ tataḥ kuru yatātmavān

atha—if; **etat**—this; **api**—even; **aśhaktaḥ**—unable; **asi**—you are; **kartum**—to work; **mad-yogam**—with devotion to Me; **āśhritaḥ**—taking refuge; **sarva-karma**—of all actions; **phala-tyāgam**—to renounce the fruits; **tataḥ**—then; **kuru**—do; **yata-ātma-vān**—be situated in the self

If you are not able to do My yoga taking refugee in Me, then renounce all actions and the fruits there of, self-controlled.

138. Chapter 12 Verses 12-13

VERSE 12.12

श्रेयो हि ज्ञानमभ्यासाज्ज्ञानाद्ध्यानं विशिष्यते ।
ध्यानात्कर्मफलत्यागस्त्यागाच्छान्तिरनन्तरम् ॥ 12 ॥

śhreyo hi jñānam abhyāsāj jñānād dhyānam viśhiṣhyate
dhyānāt karma-phala-tyāgas tyāgāch chhāntir anantaram

śhreyaḥ—better; hi—for; jñānam—knowledge; abhyāsāt—than (mechanical) practice; jñānāt—than knowledge; dhyānam—meditation; viśhiṣhyate—better; dhyānāt—than meditation; karma-phala-tyāgaḥ—renunciation of the fruits of actions; tyāgāt—renunciation; śhāntiḥ—peace; anantaram—immediately

Than practice (without discrimination) knowledge (derived from the study of the Sastras) is better indeed! than (such) knowledge, meditation is better, than meditation (stillness of mind at the time of meditation) renunciation of all fruits of action is better; immediately after renunciation peace is attained.

VERSE 12.13

अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी ॥ 13 ॥

adveṣṭā sarva-bhūtānām maitraḥ karuṇa eva cha
nirmamo nirahankāraḥ sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ kṣhamī

adveṣṭā—free from malice; **sarva-bhūtānām**—toward all living beings; **maitraḥ**—friendly; **karuṇaḥ**—compassionate; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **nirmamaḥ**—free from attachment to possession; **nirahankāraḥ**—free from egoism; **sama**—equipoised; **duḥkha**—distress; **sukhaḥ**—happiness; **kṣhamī**—forgiving;

Who does not hate any being, who is friendly and
compassionate, who is free from attachment and egoism,
who is equal-minded in sorrow and happiness, who is
forgiving, ...

139. Chapter 12 Verses 13-14

VERSE 12.13-14

अद्वेष्टा सर्वभूतानां मैत्रः करुण एव च ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः समदुःखसुखः क्षमी ॥ 13 ॥
सन्तुष्टः सततं योगी यतात्मा दृढनिश्चयः ।
मय्यर्पितमनोबुद्धिर्यो मदभक्तः स मे प्रियः ॥ 14 ॥

adveṣṭhā sarva-bhūtānām maitraḥ karuṇa eva cha
nirmamo nirahankāraḥ sama-duḥkha-sukhaḥ kṣhamī
santuṣṭhaḥ satataṁ yogī yatātmā dṛiḍha-niśhchayaḥ
mayy arpita-mano-buddhir yo mad-bhaktaḥ sa me priyaḥ

adveṣṭhā—free from malice; **sarva-bhūtānām**—toward all living beings; **maitraḥ**—friendly; **karuṇaḥ**—compassionate; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **nirmamaḥ**—free from attachment to possession; **nirahankāraḥ**—free from egoism; **sama**—equipoised; **duḥkha**—distress; **sukhaḥ**—happiness; **kṣhamī**—forgiving; **santuṣṭhaḥ**—content; **satataṁ**—steadily; **yogī**—united in devotion; **yata-ātmā**—self-controlled; **dṛiḍha-niśhchayaḥ**—firm resolve; **mayi**—to me; **arpita**—dedicated; **manaḥ**—mind; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **yaḥ**—who; **mat-bhaktaḥ**—My devotees; **saḥ**—they; **me**—to Me; **priyaḥ**—very dear

Who does not hate any being, who is friendly and
compassionate, who is free from attachment and egoism,
who is equal-minded in sorrow and happiness, who is
forgiving, who is always contented, steady in meditation,
who is self-controlled and firm in conviction, who has

surrendered his mind and intellect in Me, he (such a devotee) is dear to me.

140. Chapter 12 Verse 15

VERSE 12.15

यस्मान्नोद्विजते लोको लोकान्नोद्विजते च यः ।
हर्षामर्षभयोद्वेगैर्मुक्तो यः स च मे प्रियः ॥ 15 ॥

yasmān nodvijate loko lokān nodvijate cha yaḥ
harṣhāmarṣha-bhayodvegair mukto yaḥ sa cha me priyaḥ

yasmāt—by whom; na—not; udvijate—are agitated; lokaḥ—people; lokāt—from people; na—not; udvijate—are disturbed; cha—and; yaḥ—who; harṣha—pleasure; amarṣha—pain; bhaya—fear; udvegaiḥ—anxiety; muktaḥ—free; yaḥ—who; saḥ—they; cha—and; me—to Me; priyaḥ—very dear

He by whom the world is not afflicted and whom the world cannot afflict, he who is free from joy and anger, fear and anxiety— he is dear to Me.

141. Chapter 12 Verses 16-19

VERSE 12.16

अनपेक्षः शुचिर्दक्ष उदासीनो गतव्यथः ।
सर्वारम्भपरित्यागी यो मदभक्तः स मे प्रियः ॥ 16 ॥

anapekṣhaḥ śhuchir dakṣha udāsīno gata-vyathaḥ
sarvārambha-parityāgī yo mad-bhaktaḥ sa me priyaḥ

anapekṣhaḥ—indifferent to worldly gain; **śhuchiḥ**—pure; **dakṣhaḥ**—skillful;
udāsīnaḥ—without cares; **gata-vyathaḥ**—untroubled; **sarva-ārambha**—of all
undertakings; **parityāgī**—renouncer; **saḥ**—who; **mad-bhaktaḥ**—my devotees;
saḥ—he; **me**—to Me; **priyaḥ**—very dear

**He who is free from desire, who is pure in body and mind,
who is competent and ready-willed, who is unconcerned,
free from anxiety and sorrow, who has renounced all sense of
doership (or who has renounced all acts of desire, prohibited
by the ‘sastras’), who is devoted to Me – is dear to Me.**

VERSE 12.17

यो न हृष्यति न द्वेष्टि न शोचति न काङ्क्षति ।
शुभाशुभपरित्यागी भक्तिमान्यः स मे प्रियः ॥ 17 ॥

yo na hṛiṣhyati na dveṣṭi na śhochati na kāṅkṣati
śhubhāśhubha-parityāgī bhaktimān yaḥ sa me priyaḥ

yaḥ—who; **na**—neither; **hṛiṣhyati**—rejoice; **na**—nor; **dveṣṭi**—despair; **na**—neither; **śhochati**—lament; **na**—nor; **kāṅkṣati**—hanker for gain; **śhubha-aśhubha-parityāgī**—who renounce both good and evil deeds; **bhakti-mān**—full of devotion; **yaḥ**—who; **saḥ**—that person; **me**—to Me; **priyaḥ**—very dear

Who is not elated, who does not hate, does not grieve, who has renounced both good and bad, he, My devotee is dear to Me.

समः शत्रौ च मित्रे च तथा मानापमानयोः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु समः सङ्गविवर्जितः ॥ 18 ॥
तुल्यनिन्दास्तुतिमौनी सन्तुष्टो येन केनचित् ।
अनिकेतः स्थिरमतिर्भक्तिमान्मे प्रियो नरः ॥ 19 ॥

samaḥ śhatrau cha mitre cha tathā mānāpamānayoh
śhītoṣṇa-sukha-duḥkheṣhu samaḥ saṅga-vivarjitaḥ
tulya-nindā-stutir maunī santuṣṭo yena kenachit
aniketaḥ sthira-matir bhaktimān me priyo naraḥ

samaḥ—alike; **śhatrau**—to a foe; **cha**—and; **mitre**—to a friend; **cha tathā**—as well as; **māna-apamānayoh**—in honor and dishonor; **śhīta-uṣṇa**—in cold and heat; **sukha-duḥkheṣhu**—in joy and sorrow; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **saṅga-vivarjitaḥ**—free from all unfavorable association; **tulya**—alike; **nindā-stutiḥ**—reproach and praise; **maunī**—silent contemplation; **santuṣṭaḥ**—content; **yena kenachit**—with anything; **aniketaḥ**—without attachment to the place of residence; **sthira**—firmly fixed; **matir**—intellect; **bhakti-mān**—full of devotion; **me**—to Me; **priyaḥ**—very dear; **naraḥ**—a person

Who is equal-minded towards friends and enemies, in honour and disgrace, in heat and cold, and pleasure and pain, who is free from attachment (desire and selfishness), who is silent (meditating), who is satisfied with what-so-ever he gets, who has no particular home, who is decided in mind, who is devoted to Me, such a man is dear to Me.

142. Chapter 12 Verses 18-20

VERSE 12.18-19

समः शत्रौ च मित्रे च तथा मानापमानयोः ।
शीतोष्णसुखदुःखेषु समः सङ्गविवर्जितः ॥ 18 ॥
तुल्यनिन्दास्तुतिमौनी सन्तुष्टो येन केनचित् ।
अनिकेतः स्थिरमतिर्भक्तिमान्मे प्रियो नरः ॥ 19 ॥

samaḥ śhatrau cha mitre cha tathā mānāpamānayoḥ
śhītoṣṇa-sukha-duḥkheṣhu samaḥ saṅga-vivarjitaḥ
tulya-nindā-stutir maunī santuṣṭo yena kenachit
aniketaḥ sthira-matir bhaktimān me priyo naraḥ

samaḥ—alike; **śhatrau**—to a foe; **cha**—and; **mitre**—to a friend; **cha tathā**—as well as; **māna-apamānayoḥ**—in honor and dishonor; **śhīta-uṣṇa**—in cold and heat; **sukha-duḥkheṣhu**—in joy and sorrow; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **saṅga-vivarjitaḥ**—free from all unfavorable association; **tulya**—alike; **nindā-stutiḥ**—reproach and praise; **maunī**—silent contemplation; **santuṣṭaḥ**—content; **yena kenachit**—with anything; **aniketaḥ**—without attachment to the place of residence; **sthira**—firmly fixed; **matiḥ**—intellect; **bhakti-mān**—full of devotion; **me**—to Me; **priyaḥ**—very dear; **naraḥ**—a person

Who is equal-minded towards friends and enemies, in honour and disgrace, in heat and cold, and pleasure and pain, who is free from attachment (desire and selfishness), who is silent (meditating), who is satisfied with what-so-ever he gets, who has no particular home, who is decided in mind, who is devoted to Me, such a man is dear to Me.

VERSE 12.20

ये तु धर्म्यामृतमिदं यथोक्तं पर्युपासते ।

श्रद्धधाना मत्परमा भक्तास्तेऽतीव मे प्रियाः ॥ 20 ॥

ye tu dharmyāmṛitam idaṁ yathoktaṁ paryupāsate
śhraddadhānā mat-paramā bhaktās te 'tīva me priyāḥ

ye—who; tu—indeed; **dharma**—wisdom; **amṛitam**—nectar; **idaṁ**—this; **yathā**—
as; **uktam**—declared; **paryupāsate**—exclusive devotion; **śhraddadhānāḥ**—with
faith; **mat-paramāḥ**—intent on Me as the supreme goal; **bhaktāḥ**—devotees; **te**
—they; **atīva**—exceedingly; **me**—to Me; **priyāḥ**—dear

**Who, with faith having Me as their goal follow this immortal
and nectar-like Dharma as declared above, such devotees are
most dear to Me.**